

Chapter 5 — Parent Communication

30 prompts

The email you have been putting off is usually the one where the facts are clear but the tone is not. These prompts separate the two: state what happened, describe what you have already tried, make one specific ask — and leave out everything you cannot actually know.

WHAT'S IN HERE

GROUP	PROMPTS	USE WHEN
Positive notes	6	The highest-return five minutes in teaching
Concern emails	5	Something needs saying, carefully
Conference preparation	4	Ten minutes each, twenty-four families
Newsletters	3	Rough notes into something readable
Permissions and logistics	4	Trips, forms, deadlines
Clear and accessible language	3	Plain wording, any reading level
Difficult conversations	2	When it is already tense

WORTH KNOWING BEFORE YOU START

Describe behaviour, never character. "Three tasks are not recorded as submitted" is a fact. "He is unmotivated" is a guess about a child you are writing to their family about.

Do not let it infer a home cause. If a draft says "with support at home this will improve", cut that line — you do not know what home looks like.

Read the draft as the parent, at 8am, on a phone. Anything that reads as blame will be answered as blame.

Ask for a shorter version too. Many families will not read past four lines.

Use initials or "your child". These messages leave your classroom.

POSITIVE NOTES

PC-001 Write a specific positive family message

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Five minutes that change how a family hears everything you send afterwards.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a short positive message to a family about their child in [GRADE]
[SUBJECT].

What I actually observed: [DESCRIBE THE SPECIFIC MOMENT OR WORK. Use "your child" – no names.]

When: [DATE OR LESSON]

Rules:

- Name the specific thing. "A pleasure to teach" tells a family nothing.
- Describe what the student did, not what kind of person they are
- Two to four sentences, readable on a phone
- No "but", no concern attached, nothing asked of the family
- Do not generalise one observation into a pattern

Give me the message, and a shorter two-sentence version.

If what I described is too vague to write from, ask me what happened rather than inventing a detail.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is the specific detail genuinely yours, or has it been filled in?
- Any hidden "but" at the end?

PC-005 Share academic growth using one concrete classroom example

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Progress a family can picture, not a grade they cannot interpret.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a message to a family about academic growth in [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Where they were: [DESCRIBE, with the evidence and roughly when]

Where they are now: [DESCRIBE, with the evidence]

Build it around one concrete before-and-after that a family can picture. Not "improved in fractions" – the actual thing that changed in the work.

Give me:

- The message, under 120 words
- One sentence the family could say to their child about it
- The shorter version for a family that reads four lines

Use only what I gave you. Do not attribute the growth to effort, attitude, or anything happening at home – you do not know what caused it, and neither do I.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Would a family picture the change from this?
- Has it credited a cause you cannot actually know?

PC-006 Recognize a learner's helpful contribution without using labels

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Praising what they did, not who you have decided they are.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a short message about something helpful a [GRADE] student did:

[DESCRIBE WHAT HAPPENED. No names.]

Describe the action and its effect. Do not use character labels – not "kind", "a leader", "mature", "a role model", "responsible" or "well-behaved". A child who is told they are kind has been given something to live up to or fall short of; a child told what they did has been given something to repeat.

Give me:

- The message, three sentences
- The one line naming the effect their action had on someone else
- A version I could say aloud to the student

If my description does not contain an actual action, ask me what they did.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Any character labels left?
- Does it name a real effect, or a vague good?

PC-007 Write a brief celebration message suitable for a mobile screen

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

It will be read while walking, on a phone, in about six seconds.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a message for a family about [WHAT HAPPENED] in [GRADE] [SUBJECT], designed to be read on a phone.

Constraints:

- Under 50 words
- First line carries the whole message, in case they read nothing else
- No greeting longer than two words, no sign-off longer than my name
- One idea only
- No attachment, no link, nothing to click

Give me the message, plus the subject line – under 8 words, saying what it is so nobody opens it braced for bad news.

Then give me a version with one extra sentence, for the family who will read more.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the first line stand alone?
- Does the subject line look like good news?

PC-008 Create a positive note that invites the learner's own reflection

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The student should be in this conversation, not the subject of it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a positive message about [WHAT HAPPENED] in [GRADE] [SUBJECT] that includes the student rather than talking over them.

Give me:

- A short note to the family
- One question the family could ask their child about it, that has more than a yes or no answer
- One question I could ask the student directly
- A line the student could write themselves about what they did

The questions must be answerable by a student who is not sure what they did differently – many are not. Do not assume they can articulate it.

Keep the whole thing under 100 words.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could a student who does not know why it went well still answer?
- Does it talk to the student, or about them?

PC-009 Build a reusable strength-note template with visible evidence fields

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

So sending ten of these takes twenty minutes, not an evening.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a reusable template for positive notes home in [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

It must have blanks I fill with something real, so the note cannot be sent generic:

- [WHAT THEY DID] – a specific observed action
- [WHEN]
- [WHY IT MATTERED]

Give me:

- The template
- Four openings and four closings I can rotate, so ten notes do not read as one note sent ten times
- A worked example, filled in
- The rule for what goes in each blank, so I do not slip into vagueness at 9pm

Then tell me what makes these stop working if I send too many, and how often is too often.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could the template be sent without filling a real detail? Tighten it.
- Do ten of these read as ten different notes?

CONCERN EMAILS

PC-002 Communicate an academic concern with a next step

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The email you have been putting off since Tuesday.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write an email to a family about an academic concern in [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

The concern, factually: [WHAT IS HAPPENING – observable, with dates or counts]

What I have already tried: [LIST IT]

What I want from this email: [A MEETING / AWARENESS / A SPECIFIC NEXT STEP]

Rules:

- Open with something genuine and specific about the child
- State the concern as observable fact, not interpretation
- Describe behaviour, never character
- Do not name a cause. Do not suggest anything about home, motivation, effort, attention or ability
- Do not promise improvement
- End with one clear ask
- Under 200 words, no jargon, no emoji

Give me the email, then a four-line version for a family that will not read further.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Has it inferred a cause anywhere? Cut that line.
- Read it as the parent at 8am. Does it read as blame?
- Is there exactly one ask?

PC-010 Write a missing-work message using dates and verified counts

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Facts, not a feeling that they are behind.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a message to a family about missing work in [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

The record: [LIST WHAT IS MISSING AND THE DATES – only what I have verified]
What I have already done: [LIST IT]

Rules:

- Use only the dates and counts I gave you. Do not round, estimate, or add anything I did not state
- Do not describe the pattern as a habit, an attitude, or a choice
- Say plainly what happens next and by when
- Include how the work can be caught up, specifically
- Ask whether there is something I should know, without speculating about what

Give me the message and a short version.

Before I send this, tell me which of my stated facts I should double-check against the record – this is the kind of message where being wrong on one date loses the family's trust entirely.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Verify every date and count against your actual record.
- Has it added a number you did not give it?

PC-011 Explain a recurring learning difficulty without diagnosing its cause

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Something keeps happening, and it is not yours to name.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a message to a family about a recurring difficulty in [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

What I observe, repeatedly: [DESCRIBE THE PATTERN IN THE WORK – what happens, how often, in what situations]

Rules – these matter more than the wording:

- Describe only what I have observed in the classroom
- Name no cause. Do not suggest a diagnosis, a condition, a difficulty by name,
or anything about attention, processing, ability or home
- Do not recommend an assessment or referral – that is not mine to initiate in an email
- Ask what the family notices, rather than telling them what to look for
- Say what I am doing about it in the classroom already

Give me the message under 180 words.

If anything in my description is already a diagnosis in disguise, tell me and rewrite it as an observation.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Any language that hints at a diagnosis? Cut it.
- Follow your school's process for anything beyond an observation.

PC-012 Request a brief family check-in with two exact scheduling options

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Making it easy to say yes.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a short message asking a family for a brief conversation about [TOPIC].

My availability: [TWO SPECIFIC OPTIONS – day, date, time, duration]

How: [PHONE / IN PERSON / VIDEO]

Rules:

- Say why in one sentence, without loading it
- Offer exactly the two options I gave, plus an invitation to suggest another
- Say how long it will take
- Make clear this is not an emergency, if it is not
- Do not make attendance sound compulsory unless it is

Under 100 words.

Then give me a second version for a family who has not responded to two previous messages – same content, different approach, no reproach about the silence.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does it read as urgent when it is not?
- Is the non-response version free of any hint of blame?

PC-013 Revise a blaming concern email into factual collaborative language

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You wrote it angry. Do not send that one.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite this message so it is factual and collaborative, keeping every fact intact.

Do not soften it into meaninglessness – the family must still understand there is a problem and what happens next.

Show me:

- Each sentence carrying blame, judgement, or an inference about home, character or motivation – quoted
- What is factually true in it, and what is my interpretation presented as fact
- The rewritten message
- Anything I claimed that I should verify before sending

Give me three versions: gentle, direct, and firm. Tell me which fits what I described, and when I would use each of the others.

DRAFT:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are all the facts still there, or did softening remove one?
- Verify anything it flagged as unchecked.

PC-014 Audit a concern message for evidence, tone and unsupported claims

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before it becomes the email that gets forwarded to the head.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this message to a family.

Tell me:

- Every claim not supported by something I could show – quoted
- Anywhere I describe character rather than behaviour
- Anywhere I imply a cause: home, effort, attitude, ability, attention
- Anywhere a family could reasonably read blame
- Whether the ask is clear, single, and actually answerable
- What a defensive family would seize on first
- Anything a family might reasonably ask that the message does not answer

Then give me the one sentence I should cut, and why.

MESSAGE:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Cut the sentence it named. That is the one.
- Could you evidence every remaining claim if asked?

CONFERENCE PREPARATION

PC-003 Prepare a balanced family conference

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Ten minutes, and you want them to leave knowing three things.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Prepare me for a [MINUTES]-minute conference with a family in [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

What I know: [STRENGTHS WITH EVIDENCE, GROWTH AREA WITH EVIDENCE, ANYTHING ELSE – no names]

Give me a single card I can glance at:

- One strength, with the evidence in a phrase
- One growth area, with the evidence in a phrase
- One question to ask the family, that is genuinely open
- One thing they could do at home that costs under ten minutes and does not require them to teach anything
- The sentence I open with, and the sentence I close with

Keep it to what fits on half a page. I will be reading it while they sit down.

Do not include anything I did not give you, and do not invent an evidence detail to make a point land better.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is every piece of evidence something you actually have?
- Could you deliver this in ten minutes with the family talking too?

PC-015 Build a 15-minute conference agenda around learning evidence

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Structure, so the ten minutes do not disappear into small talk.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a [MINUTES]-minute conference agenda for [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

Give me the agenda with minutes allocated to each part, including:

- Time for the family to talk, which is the part that always gets squeezed
- Where I show actual work rather than describe it
- Where the student's own view comes in, if they are present
- The point at which I stop and check whether we agree on what we are seeing
- What I do when we reach the last two minutes and nothing is settled

Then tell me:

- Which part to cut first if we are running over
- The conversation this agenda does not handle – the one that needs a separate meeting – and how I recognise it early and say so

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does the family get real time, or a token minute?
- Could you say "this needs a longer conversation" comfortably?

PC-016 Prepare questions that invite family and student perspective

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You do most of the talking. That is the wrong way round.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write questions for a [GRADE] conference that get the family and the student talking.

Give me:

- Three questions for the family, open, none of which can be answered "fine"
- Three for the student, answerable by a student who is nervous or monosyllabic
- One question I ask when the family disagrees with something I have said
- One I ask when the family says nothing at all

Rules:

- No question assuming a particular home setup, language, work schedule, resources or family structure
- Nothing that reads as checking whether they are doing enough at home
- Nothing that puts a child on the spot in front of an adult

Then tell me which question is most likely to open something I am not prepared for, and how to hold that well.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does any question assume a kind of household?
- Would a nervous 9-year-old manage the student questions?

PC-017 Turn classroom evidence into a shared action-plan table

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

So the meeting produces something rather than just happening.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Turn this into a shared action plan after a conference in [GRADE] [SUBJECT]:

What we discussed: [SUMMARISE – no names]

What was agreed: [LIST IT]

Give me a table with: what will happen, who does it, by when, and how we will know it worked.

Rules:

- Every row has a named owner – me, the family, or the student. No unowned rows
- Nothing asks a family to teach subject content
- Nothing requires resources, internet, or an adult free at a fixed time, unless the family offered it
- The student owns at least one row
- Include a date to check back, and who initiates that

Only include what was actually agreed. If something was discussed but not agreed, list it separately as open.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Does every row have an owner?
- Is anything here the family did not actually agree to?

PC-018 Write a factual post-conference summary with owners and dates

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A record, sent the same day, that both sides recognise.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a summary email after a family conference in [GRADE] [SUBJECT].

What was discussed: [YOUR NOTES – no names]

What was agreed: [LIST IT]

Rules:

- Record only what was said and agreed. Do not smooth over a disagreement, and do not record agreement that was not given
- Where the family and I saw it differently, record both views neutrally
- Every action has an owner and a date
- No new information, no new concerns – this is a record, not a second email
- Invite correction: they may remember it differently, and that is fine

Under 200 words.

Then tell me what to do if the family replies disputing the summary.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Send it the same day. Memory diverges fast.
- Have you recorded agreement that was not actually given?

NEWSLETTERS

PC-004 Draft a useful class newsletter

Grades K-2, 3-5

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Bullet points in, something families actually read out.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Turn these notes into a class newsletter for [GRADE] families, week of [DATE]:

[PASTE YOUR ROUGH NOTES]

Sections: what we learned, what is coming, dates to remember, one thing to do at home.

Rules:

- Under 300 words, headings, scannable in thirty seconds
- Dates in full – day, date, month – never "next Tuesday"
- The home suggestion takes under ten minutes and needs no printing, internet, or subject knowledge
- No school jargon, no acronyms
- Written for any adult at any reading level

Give me the newsletter, then a five-line version for families who will not read the full one.

Use only what is in my notes. If a date or detail is missing, ask rather than filling it in.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check every date against the calendar yourself.
- Has anything been invented to fill a section?

PC-019 Create a concise weekly learning update for families

Grades 3-5, 6-8, 9-12

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Same shape every week, so families know where to look.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Build a repeatable weekly update format for [GRADE] [SUBJECT] families.

Give me:

- A fixed structure, four sections maximum, in the same order every week
- What goes in each, written as a rule so I can fill it in five minutes
- This week's version, using: [YOUR NOTES]
- The one section families will actually read, placed first
- What to do in a week where little happened, without padding

Under 200 words.

Then tell me what makes families stop reading a weekly update, so I can avoid building that in from the start.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Could you fill this in five minutes every week? If not, simplify it.
- Is the most-read section first?

PC-021 Audit a class newsletter for dates, jargon, access and action items

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Before three families turn up on the wrong day.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this newsletter for [GRADE] families.

Check:

- Every date and day-of-week – flag any that is ambiguous, relative, or that I should verify
- School jargon, acronyms and internal shorthand, quoted
- Anything assuming internet, a printer, money, transport, or a free adult
- Anything a family is being asked to do that is not stated clearly as an ask
- Whether the reading level suits every family, not most of them
- Whether the most important item is buried

Then tell me the three items to move to the top, and everything I could cut without loss.

NEWSLETTER:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Verify every flagged date against the school calendar.
- Are the asks unmistakably asks?

PC-020 Rewrite a newsletter as a mobile-friendly plain-text version

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Most families will open this on a phone, in a queue, with one thumb.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite this newsletter as plain text for a phone screen.

Rules:

- No formatting that depends on a wide screen – no columns, no tables, no boxes, no indentation carrying meaning
- Most important item first, in the first two lines
- Short paragraphs, two or three lines each, with a blank line between
- Dates in full, on their own line, so they survive being screenshotted
- No attachment and no link required to understand the message
- Under 200 words

Give me:

- The plain-text version
- A three-line version for a text message or messaging app
- Which items I should send separately instead, because they will be lost in a long message

Keep every date and deadline exactly as written.

NEWSLETTER:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Read it on your own phone before sending.
- Did any date change in the rewrite?

PERMISSIONS AND LOGISTICS

PC-022 Draft a permission notice from verified trip or event details

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

A form that comes back complete, first time.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a permission notice for [EVENT] for [GRADE] families.

Verified details: [DATE, TIMES, LOCATION, TRANSPORT, COST, WHAT TO BRING, WHAT TO WEAR, RETURN DEADLINE, WHO TO CONTACT]

Rules:

- Use only the details I supplied. Invent nothing – not a cost, not a time, not a policy, not a supervision ratio
- If something a permission notice normally contains is missing from my list, list it as missing rather than filling it in
- Plain language, short sentences, translation-ready
- Say clearly what happens if a family cannot pay or cannot consent, without requiring them to explain why
- One clear return deadline and one place to return it

Give me the notice and the tear-off slip.

I will check this against my school's own consent and safeguarding requirements before it goes out.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Check every detail against the actual arrangements.
- Check the form against your school's required consent wording.
- Fill in anything it listed as missing — do not send it with gaps.

PC-023 Create a clear family checklist for materials, dates and return forms

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

One list, so nothing arrives on the wrong day.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Turn these into a family checklist for [GRADE]:

[LIST WHAT IS NEEDED, WITH DATES]

Rules:

- Grouped by date, earliest first, with the full date each time
- Each item says what, by when, and where it goes
- Say which items are essential and which are optional – families need to know what they can skip
- For anything costing money or needing a purchase, note the school's route for families who cannot
- Nothing requiring a printer at home

Give me the checklist as one page, plus a two-line phone summary of the most urgent items.

Use only my list. If a date is missing, ask.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is essential versus optional actually accurate?
- Is your school's support route stated correctly?

PC-024 Write a schedule-change notice without inventing school policy

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Something moved, and families need to know today.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Write a notice about a schedule change for [GRADE] families.

What changed: [OLD ARRANGEMENT → NEW ARRANGEMENT]

Effective: [DATE]

Reason I am permitted to share: [STATE IT, or say none]

Rules:

- Lead with the change. The reason, if any, comes second
- State no policy, procedure or entitlement I have not given you
- If families will ask something this notice cannot answer, say who to ask rather than guessing
- Do not apologise repeatedly; say it once if warranted
- Do not speculate about further changes

Under 100 words, plus a one-line version for a text message.

If the reason I gave should not be shared with families, say so.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Has it stated a policy you did not give it?
- Is the reason yours to share?

PC-025 Audit a logistics message for missing consent, safety and contact details

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The message that will generate forty replies asking the same question.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this logistics message to [GRADE] families.

Tell me:

- What a family needs to know that is missing – timing, location, cost, supervision, what to bring, what to do if they cannot
- Any consent, medical or emergency-contact element that appears incomplete
- Every ambiguous date, time or place, quoted
- Anything stated as policy that I should verify before sending
- The three questions families will email me about after reading this
- Anything assuming a family has a car, a smartphone, spare money, or a free weekday

Then tell me the single addition that would prevent the most replies.

I will check all consent and safeguarding elements against my school's own requirements.

MESSAGE:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Add the missing items before sending, not after the questions arrive.
- Take the consent and safeguarding flags to your school's process.

CLEAR AND ACCESSIBLE LANGUAGE

PC-026 Rewrite school language in plain family-friendly English

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

The message is accurate and nobody outside the staffroom understands it.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite this message for [GRADE] families in plain English.

Rules:

- Replace every acronym, initialism and piece of school jargon with what it actually means
- Short sentences, one idea each
- Active voice – say who does what, rather than "it has been decided"
- Keep every fact and every deadline exactly as they are
- Do not make it warmer by making it vaguer

Give me:

- The rewritten message
- A table of what you changed and why
- Any term I must keep for accuracy, with a plain gloss beside it
- Anywhere the original was ambiguous, so I can decide what it meant rather than you guessing

MESSAGE:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Did any fact or deadline shift in the rewrite?
- Where it flagged ambiguity, decide it yourself.

PC-027 Create a translation-ready message using short unambiguous sentences

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

It will go through machine translation, and idioms do not survive that.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Rewrite this message for [GRADE] families so it survives machine translation.

Rules:

- One idea per sentence, under 15 words where possible
- No idioms, phrasal verbs, metaphors, humour or cultural references
- No sarcasm, no understatement
- Consistent terms – do not call the same thing two different names
- Dates written in full, unambiguously – not 03/04, which means two different days in two countries
- Avoid words with several meanings where a plainer word exists

Give me the rewritten message, and a list of anything I should have a person check rather than trusting to translation.

Do not lose any fact in the simplification.

MESSAGE:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Is every date unambiguous?
- Have the facts survived intact?

PC-028 Audit a family message for jargon, idioms and hidden assumptions

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

Checking what the message quietly assumes about a family.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Audit this message to families.

Flag and quote:

- Jargon, acronyms and school shorthand
- Idioms and phrasal verbs that will not translate
- Assumptions about the family: two parents, English at home, a car, internet, a printer, spare money, someone free during the school day, a quiet room, a parent who can help with the subject
- Anything implying a family is not doing enough
- Any sentence with two possible readings
- Anything requiring a reading level above straightforward everyday English

Then give me the single sentence most likely to make a family feel judged, and a replacement.

MESSAGE:

[PASTE IT]

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- The judged-feeling sentence: replace it, do not defend it.
- Which assumption surprised you? That is the useful one.

DIFFICULT CONVERSATIONS

PC-029 Prepare a calm conversation about a repeated classroom concern

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

It has come up before, and this conversation needs to go better than the last.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Prepare me for a conversation with a family about a repeated concern in [GRADE].

What keeps happening: [OBSERVABLE FACTS, WITH DATES]

What has already been tried: [BY ME, AND BY THE FAMILY IF I KNOW]

What I want from this conversation: [STATE IT]

Give me:

- My opening, under 30 seconds, that states the concern without a preamble that makes it sound worse
- The facts in the order I say them
- What I say when the family disagrees with the facts
- What I say when the family becomes upset
- What I say when the family says it is my responsibility, or the school's
- The point at which I stop and listen rather than continuing
- How I close if nothing is resolved

Do not script the family's side. Do not assume they will be difficult.

Nothing here should involve me guessing at causes at home.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- Are the facts verified, with dates?
- Are you prepared to actually stop and listen at that point?

PC-030 Create a fact-based communication plan for disagreement with a family

All grades

WHEN YOU NEED THIS

You and the family see it differently, and it needs handling rather than winning.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Help me plan communication with a family who disagrees with me about [ISSUE] in [GRADE].

Their position, as I understand it: [DESCRIBE IT FAIRLY]
My position, and the evidence: [DESCRIBE IT]

Give me:

- What we actually agree on, which is usually more than it feels like
- Where the disagreement genuinely sits – fact, interpretation, or what should happen next. These need different handling and I want to know which this is
- What I would need to see to change my view, stated honestly
- What is not negotiable, and why, in one sentence a family can accept
- What I put in writing and what stays a conversation
- When this stops being mine to handle alone, and who I involve

Do not tell me how to win this. If the family may be right, say so.

I will follow my school's procedures for anything formal.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

- If it said the family may be right, sit with that before replying.
- Involve your school's process at the point it named, not later.